The PEEPO Framework

The systematic way to find root causes in incident investigations

P	E	E	P	O
People	Environment	Equipment	Procedures	Organization

Swipe to learn each →

P

People

Physical State

- Fatigue / sleep
- Illness / injury
- Impairment

Mental State

- Stress / pressure
- Distraction
- Complacency

Knowledge

- Training adequacy
- Experience level
- Hazard awareness

Communication

- Instructions clear?
- Language barriers?
- Handover adequate?

💡 **KEY INSIGHT**

People factors explain HOW an incident happened — but rarely WHY it was possible. Always dig deeper.

E

Environment

Physical Conditions

- Weather
- Lighting
- Noise / temperature

Workspace

- Housekeeping
- Layout / access
- Ground conditions

Temporal

- Time of day
- Shift patterns
- End of shift rush

Location

- Remote / isolated
- Multi-employer site
- Public interface

💡 **KEY INSIGHT**

Even the most skilled worker can fail in a hostile environment. The environment sets the stage.

E

Equipment

Design

- Suitable for task?
- Ergonomic?
- Fails safely?

Condition

- Maintenance status
- Known defects?
- Pre-use checks done?

Safety Features

- Guards in place?
- Interlocks working?
- E-stops accessible?

PPE

- Available?
- Good condition?
- Correct for hazard?

💡 KEY INSIGHT

Equipment doesn't maintain itself. Ask: who decided on maintenance schedules and budgets?

P

Procedures

Availability

- Does it exist?
- Accessible?
- Right format?

Quality

- Accurate?
- Complete?
- Up to date?

Practicality

- Can it be followed?
- Time to follow it?
- Resources available?

Compliance

- Workers know it?
- Trained on it?
- Actually followed?

💡 **KEY INSIGHT**

If workers routinely deviate from procedures, the procedure is the problem — not the workers.

O

Organization

Management Systems

- Risk assessment
- Change management
- Permits / audits

Resources

- Staffing levels
- Budget allocation
- Time / schedules

Culture

- Safety priority
- Reporting culture
- Just culture

Competing Pressures

- Production vs safety
- Cost pressure
- Schedule pressure

💡 **THIS IS WHERE ROOT CAUSES LIVE**

Every P-E-E-P factor traces back to an organizational decision. Don't stop until you find it.

The Complete Picture

P — **People**
Human factors and individual actions

E — **Environment**
Physical conditions and surroundings

E — **Equipment**
Tools, machinery, and PPE

P — **Procedures**
Work methods and documentation

O — **Organization**
Management systems and culture ← Root causes

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